

E022

# Product Strategy

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

**What this is.** Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

**Source.** Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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# How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | _____  |                               |

# Items

1.

A sales director at a payroll software company insists the team build a custom-report builder because one large client asked for it. The client has been a customer for eight years and pays \$250,000 a year. No other users have been asked. What should the product manager do first?

- A. Write detailed technical specifications for the report builder.
- B. Research what problem the client is trying to solve and whether other users share it.
- C. Decline, since single-client requests should never be built.
- D. Build it, since a large client asked.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

2.

A team building a scheduling tool for home-care nurses does not yet understand how nurses plan their days or where they struggle. The team has a \$15,000 research budget and a designer who joined last month. Which method fits best now?

- A. A/B testing two versions of the app.
- B. Reviewing web analytics from the company site.
- C. A large survey with fixed multiple-choice questions.
- D. Contextual interviews and shadowing nurses during their shifts.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Interviews revealed three pain points. The team now needs to know what share of 20,000 customers experience each one. Which method fits?

- A. More one-on-one interviews.
- B. A single focus group.
- C. A survey sent to a representative sample of customers.
- D. Ask the sales team for their opinion.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

4.

For a new patient-intake app built with a partner agency in Chicago, the spec says: “Search results must load within 2 seconds for 95% of queries.” The agency’s last project won a design award. What type of requirement is this?

- A. Functional.
- B. Business requirement.
- C. Not a requirement, since only features count.
- D. Non-functional.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement is a functional requirement?

- A. “The system shall be available 99.9% of the time.”
- B. “Reduce support calls about passwords by 30%.”
- C. “The system shall let a user reset a password by email link.”
- D. “All stored passwords shall be hashed.”

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

6.

Feature A reaches 2,000 users a quarter, has impact 2, confidence 80%, and effort 4 person-months. Feature B reaches 500 users, has impact 3, confidence 100%, and effort 1 person-month. The CEO mentioned Feature A in an all-hands meeting. Using RICE, which feature ranks higher?

- A. Feature B, score 1,500 vs. 800.
- B. Feature A, score 12,800 vs. 1,500.
- C. Feature A, because it reaches four times as many users.
- D. Feature A, because the CEO mentioned it.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**7.** [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A feature has reach 1,200, impact 2, confidence 50%, and a RICE score of 300. What effort (in person-months) was used?

- A.** 4
- B.** 0.25
- C.** 8
- D.** 2

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**8.**

A startup believes small landlords will pay for automated rent reminders. The founders want to build reminders, a full accounting module, tenant screening, and a mobile app before showing anyone. They rent a shared office downtown. What is the best MVP approach?

- A.** Wait until all features are complete so users are impressed.
- B.** Build all four modules at lower quality to launch fast.
- C.** Offer a simple reminder service to a few landlords and see if they pay.
- D.** Build the accounting module first since it is most complex.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**9.**

A language-learning app's board deck shows total registered users rising from 1 million to 1.4 million. The company's mascot is a cartoon owl. Weekly active learners fell 20% over the same period. Which metric should the product team focus on?

- A.** Total registered users, since it keeps rising.
- B.** Weekly active learners and retention.
- C.** Both are equally useful because all growth is good.
- D.** App store downloads.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

10.

A subscription analytics tool charges \$50 a month per customer at an 80% gross margin, with 2% monthly churn. It spends \$500 to acquire each customer, and its sales team works from Austin. What is customer lifetime value?

- A. \$2,000
- B. \$2,500
- C. \$0.80
- D. \$500

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A product's LTV is \$1,800 and leadership requires an LTV:CAC ratio of at least 3:1. What is the most it can spend to acquire a customer?

- A. \$450
- B. \$1,800
- C. \$5,400
- D. \$600

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

12.

A product manager with a computer science degree tells the engineers which database and framework to use for a new feature. The engineering lead disagrees on technical grounds. The team sits on the fourth floor. What is the best view of the PM's role here?

- A. The PM decides because of the computer science degree.
- B. The PM should define the problem, outcomes, and constraints, and let engineering choose the technical approach.
- C. The PM decides because PMs are the team's manager.
- D. The PM should step away from the feature entirely.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

# STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

# Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

## 1. Answer B Concept 1

A sales director at a payroll software company insists the team build a custom-report builder because one large client asked for it. ~~The client has been a customer for eight years and pays \$250,000 a year.~~ No other users have been asked. What should the product manager do first?

**Target word:** first step **Decides:** The need has not been validated beyond one request.

|          |                    |                                                            |
|----------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Inverted operation | Jumps to solution design before the problem is known.      |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Validate the problem before committing to a solution.      |
| C        | Absolute language  | Some single requests reveal broad needs; research decides. |
| D        | Camouflage         | Client size does not validate the need.                    |

## 2. Answer D Concept 2

A team building a scheduling tool for home-care nurses does not yet understand how nurses plan their days or where they struggle. ~~The team has a \$15,000 research budget and a designer who joined last month.~~ Which method fits best now?

**Target word:** method for discovering unknown needs **Decides:** The team needs to learn “why/how,” not measure known factors.

|          |                    |                                                                                       |
|----------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Adjacent category  | Evaluative; there is no app to test yet.                                              |
| B        | Confusion set      | Shows site behavior, not how nurses plan care.                                        |
| C        | Inverted operation | Surveys measure known options; they cannot surface needs the team has not thought of. |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Qualitative observation uncovers unknown needs.                                       |

## 3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

Interviews revealed three pain points. The team now needs to know what share of 20,000 customers experience each one. Which method fits?

**Target word:** reverse: measure how many **Decides:** The question is quantitative.

|          |                    |                                          |
|----------|--------------------|------------------------------------------|
| A        | Inverted operation | Great for why, too few to measure share. |
| B        | Adjacent category  | Qualitative and small.                   |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Quantitative methods size known issues.  |
| D        | Confusion set      | Secondhand and not measured.             |

## 4. Answer D Concept 3

For a new patient-intake app ~~built with a partner agency in Chicago~~, the spec says: “Search results must load within 2 seconds for 95% of queries.” ~~The agency’s last project won a design award.~~ What type of requirement is this?

**Target word:** classify the requirement **Decides:** It sets a quality (speed), not a behavior.

|          |                   |                                                              |
|----------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Confusion set     | Functional would be “the user can search for a patient.”     |
| B        | Adjacent category | Business requirements state goals like reducing intake time. |
| C        | Absolute language | Quality attributes are requirements.                         |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Performance targets are non-functional.                      |



## 5. Answer C Concept 3 · transfer

Which statement is a functional requirement?

**Target word:** reverse: pick the functional one **Decides:** Functional = what the system does.

|   |                    |                                     |
|---|--------------------|-------------------------------------|
| A | Inverted operation | Availability is non-functional.     |
| B | Adjacent category  | A business goal.                    |
| C | <b>Correct</b>     | Describes a behavior.               |
| D | Confusion set      | A security quality: non-functional. |

## 6. Answer A Concept 4

Feature A reaches 2,000 users a quarter, has impact 2, confidence 80%, and effort 4 person-months. Feature B reaches 500 users, has impact 3, confidence 100%, and effort 1 person-month. ~~The CEO mentioned Feature A in an all hands meeting.~~ Using RICE, which feature ranks higher?

**Target word:** RICE ranking **Decides:**  $A = 2,000 \times 2 \times 0.8 \div 4 = 800$ ;  $B = 500 \times 3 \times 1 \div 1 = 1,500$ .

|   |                    |                                           |
|---|--------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>     | Effort divides A's score sharply.         |
| B | Inverted operation | Multiplies by effort instead of dividing. |
| C | Dropped element    | Ranks by reach alone.                     |
| D | Camouflage         | The mention does not enter the score.     |

## 7. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

A feature has reach 1,200, impact 2, confidence 50%, and a RICE score of 300. What effort (in person-months) was used?

**Target word:** solve for effort **Decides:**  $\text{Effort} = (1,200 \times 2 \times 0.5) \div 300$ .

|   |                    |                                 |
|---|--------------------|---------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>     | $1,200 \div 300 = 4$ .          |
| B | Inverted operation | Divides score by the numerator. |
| C | Dropped element    | Leaves out the 50% confidence.  |
| D | Wrong stem number  | The impact value.               |

## 8. Answer C Concept 5

A startup believes small landlords will pay for automated rent reminders. The founders want to build reminders, a full accounting module, tenant screening, and a mobile app before showing anyone. ~~They rent a shared office downtown.~~ What is the best MVP approach?

**Target word:** scope of MVP **Decides:** The riskiest assumption is willingness to pay for reminders.

|   |                    |                                                                       |
|---|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Inverted operation | Delays learning.                                                      |
| B | Confusion set      | MVP is minimum scope for learning, not minimum quality of everything. |
| C | <b>Correct</b>     | Tests the riskiest assumption with the least build.                   |
| D | Adjacent category  | Complexity is not the assumption at risk.                             |

## 9. Answer B Concept 6

A language-learning app's board deck shows total registered users rising from 1 million to 1.4 million. ~~The company's mascot is a cartoon owl.~~ Weekly active learners fell 20% over the same period. Which metric should the product team focus on?

**Target word:** actionable metric **Decides:** Cumulative sign-ups cannot fall; engagement shows value.

|          |                    |                                                      |
|----------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Inverted operation | A vanity metric that can only go up.                 |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Tied to user value and falling — a signal to act on. |
| C        | Absolute language  | Not all numbers inform decisions.                    |
| D        | Adjacent category  | Another top-of-funnel count, not value.              |

## 10. Answer A Concept 7

A subscription analytics tool charges \$50 a month per customer at an 80% gross margin, with 2% monthly churn. It spends \$500 to acquire each customer, ~~and its sales team works from Austin.~~ What is customer lifetime value?

**Target word:** LTV **Decides:**  $\$50 \times 0.80 \div 0.02$ .

|          |                    |                                                       |
|----------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | $\$40 \text{ margin per month} \div 0.02 = \$2,000$ . |
| B        | Dropped element    | Leaves out gross margin.                              |
| C        | Inverted operation | Multiplies by churn instead of dividing.              |
| D        | Wrong stem number  | That is CAC.                                          |

## 11. Answer D Concept 7 • transfer

A product's LTV is \$1,800 and leadership requires an LTV:CAC ratio of at least 3:1. What is the most it can spend to acquire a customer?

**Target word:** solve for maximum CAC **Decides:**  $\text{CAC} = \text{LTV} \div 3$ .

|          |                    |                                               |
|----------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| A        | Wrong stem number  | Uses a 4:1 ratio not in the stem.             |
| B        | Adjacent category  | That is break-even (1:1), not the 3:1 target. |
| C        | Inverted operation | Multiplies instead of dividing.               |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | $\$1,800 \div 3 = \$600$ .                    |

## 12. Answer B Concept 8

A product manager ~~with a computer science degree~~ tells the engineers which database and framework to use for a new feature. The engineering lead disagrees on technical grounds. ~~The team sits on the fourth floor.~~ What is the best view of the PM's role here?

**Target word:** who decides what **Decides:** Technical "how" belongs to engineering.

|          |                    |                                                              |
|----------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Camouflage         | Background does not change role boundaries.                  |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | PM owns why and what; engineering owns how.                  |
| C        | Confusion set      | PMs usually lead through influence, not reporting authority. |
| D        | Inverted operation | The PM still owns the problem and outcomes.                  |

## Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

|                       | Right                                                 | Wrong                                                                                 |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sure</b>           | Owned.                                                | <b>Concept inversion — top priority.</b> A wrong mental model; it survives rewording. |
| <b>Unsure / guess</b> | Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer. | Not learned yet.                                                                      |

## Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

| Trap               | What it does                                                 | In this drill | Your misses |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|
| Dropped element    | Leaves out a required term or step.                          | 3             |             |
| Wrong stem number  | A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.      | 3             |             |
| Adjacent category  | The right idea in the wrong bucket.                          | 7             |             |
| Inverted operation | Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower. | 11            |             |
| Absolute language  | Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.           | 3             |             |
| Confusion set      | Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.       | 6             |             |
| Camouflage         | Answers a stem fact that was never the question.             | 3             |             |

## Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

| # | Concept                                     | Rule                                                                                                                                                                          | Trap                                                                                 | Tell                                                                   |
|---|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Problem before solution</b>              | Validate that a real user problem (the job to be done) exists and matters before committing to a solution.                                                                    | Building the feature a stakeholder asked for without confirming the underlying need. | A proposed feature with no evidence of the user problem.               |
| 2 | <b>Choosing research methods</b>            | Qualitative methods (interviews, observation) explain why and uncover needs; quantitative methods (surveys, analytics) measure how many and how much.                         | Using a survey to discover unknown needs, or interviews to size a market.            | Whether the question is “why/what” or “how many.”                      |
| 3 | <b>Types of requirements</b>                | Business requirements state goals; functional requirements state what the system does; non-functional requirements state qualities such as speed, security, and availability. | Labeling a performance or security target as functional.                             | A requirement with a measurable quality (seconds, uptime, encryption). |
| 4 | <b>RICE prioritization</b>                  | $RICE = Reach \times Impact \times Confidence \div Effort$ ; higher scores go first.                                                                                          | Ranking by reach alone or multiplying by effort.                                     | Reach, impact, confidence, and effort values for competing features.   |
| 5 | <b>Minimum viable product</b>               | An MVP is the smallest thing that tests the riskiest assumption with real users; its goal is learning.                                                                        | Treating MVP as a low-quality version 1 with every feature.                          | A team debating how much to build before launch.                       |
| 6 | <b>Actionable vs. vanity metrics</b>        | Good product metrics tie to user value and decisions (activation, retention); vanity metrics grow without showing value (total sign-ups, page views).                         | Celebrating cumulative totals that can only go up.                                   | A metric that never decreases.                                         |
| 7 | <b>Unit economics: LTV and CAC</b>          | $LTV = \text{monthly revenue per user} \times \text{gross margin} \div \text{monthly churn}$ ; a healthy LTV:CAC is about 3:1 or better.                                      | Leaving out gross margin or inverting churn.                                         | ARPU, margin, churn, and acquisition cost in one stem.                 |
| 8 | <b>Product manager's role and influence</b> | The PM owns the why and what (problem, outcomes, priorities); engineering owns the how; PMs lead through influence, not authority.                                            | PM dictating technical design or acting as the team's boss.                          | A disagreement about who decides.                                      |

**Course scope (public description):** Product Strategy prepares students to plan a new product's development. Students will strategize the needs, requirements, costs, and metrics to determine a successful design. The course covers skills in new product development, product knowledge, product management, user research, product planning, business requirements, and team leadership. There are no prerequisites for this course.